

A short introduction to comparative clauses (of equality)

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1. CONTENTS

- Scope of the research (§ 2)
- Comparison clauses and semantic functions (§ 3)
- Syntactic contexts: comparison and layers of the clause (§ 4)
- Description of the comparative clauses (§ 5-8)
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Clauses and other constituents expressing equality comparison:

- English: *as, like, ...*
- German: *wie, als ...*
- Spanish: *como, ...*
- Modern Greek: *όπως (και), σαν, καθώς (και), τόσο ... όσο ...*
- Ancient Greek: *ὥς, ὥσπερ, ἄτε, ...*
- Latin: *ut, ...*

3. COMPARISON AND OTHER SEMANTIC FUNCTIONS

Function	Subordinate	NP	Adverb	PP
Time	Temporal clauses before you came	the day before	then before that day	
Cause	Cause clauses because you came		due to that, for that reason	
Condition	Conditional clauses if/in case you come...		else, then, otherwise	in that case
Concession	Concessive clauses although you came ...		even then	despite ...
Purpose	Purpose clauses for ... to ..., in order to come			for
...	...	...	...	...
?Manner	Comparative clauses as, like ¹	?	?	like?

Note: Absent from grammars like Rijksbaron 2006 (Ancient Greek)

- **Problems:**

1. Semantic function. In grammars 'comparison' is not established as a semantic function in contrast to other functions.
2. Alternative expressions. Although there are some voids, it is possible to enumerate other kinds of constituents displaying the same function as subordinate clauses of Time, Cause, Concession, Purpose, and so on. That is not that easy in the case of comparison clauses.
3. Manner. If we equate comparison of equality with Manner ('in the X way'), this function does not cover but a minimal part of the range of semantic meanings conveyed by comparative clauses of equality.

- **Solutions:**

1. Description of their syntactic and semantic scope of action.
2. Description of the values conveyed by comparative clauses.

4. SYNTACTIC CONTEXTS

1. Comparatives as a constituent of the clause > § 4.1.
2. Comparatives as modifiers of other constituents > § 4.2.

4.1. LAYERS OF THE CLAUSE

- Structure of the clause: Dik 1997, Dik et alii 1990, Hengeveld 1990.
- Typology of entities: Lyons 1977.

(1) **To be honest , probably today** I won't **properly** explain my paper

To be honest, probably today I won't properly explain my paper

σ_4 σ_3 σ_2 Arg σ_1 Arg

SoA (2nd)

Proposition (3rd)

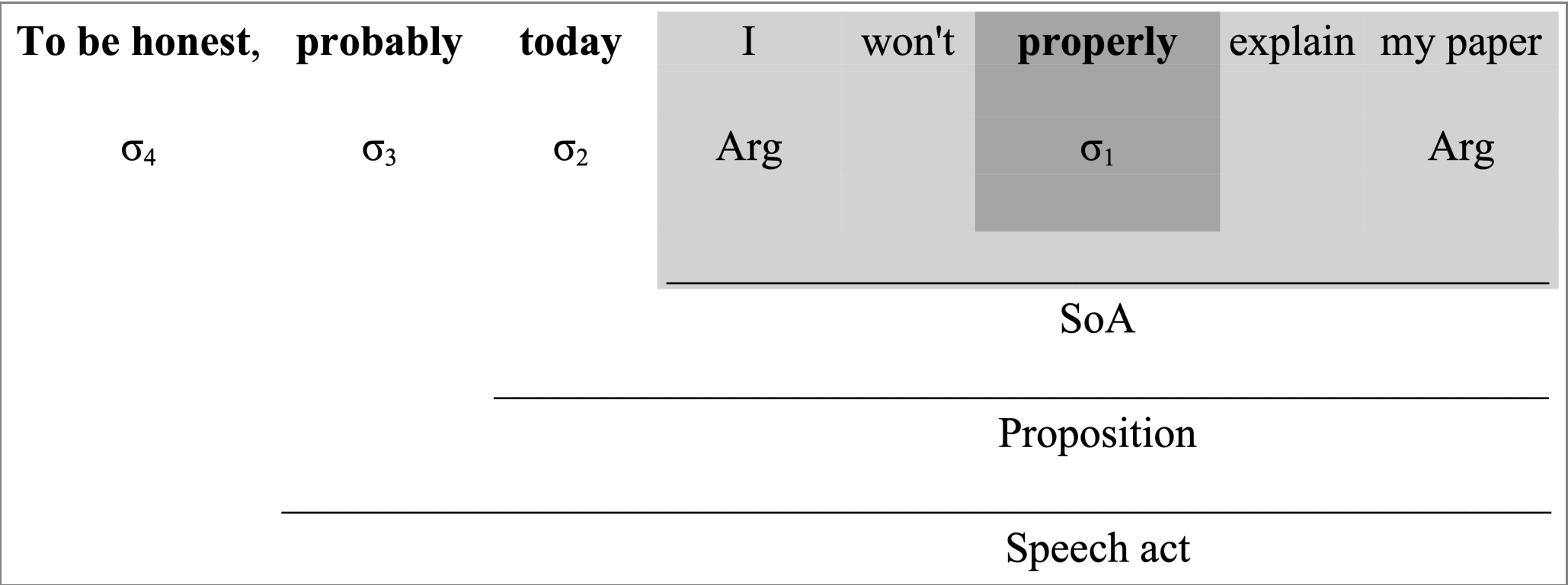
Speech act (4th)

ARGUMENT/SATELLITES1 (ADJUNCTS) OF THE SOA

State of Affairs (SoA)

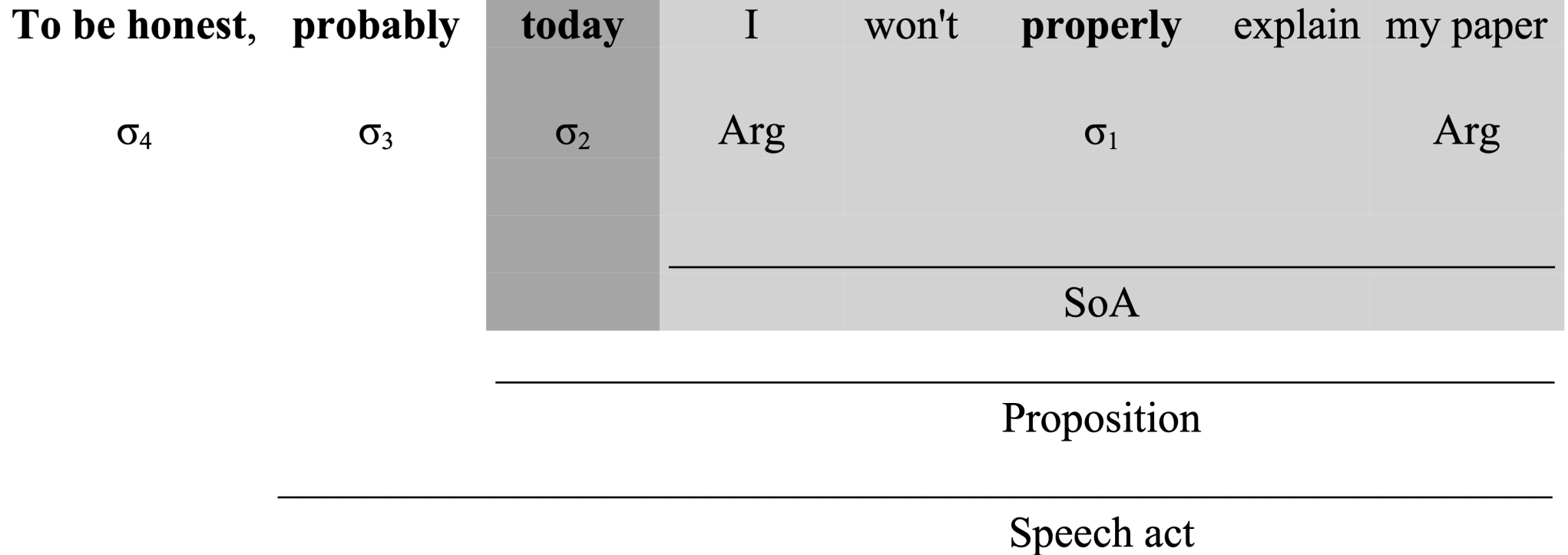
- 1. Something that can happen and be perceived (2nd order entity)
- 2. It is described by the verb and the arguments and some σ_1 satellites (first level adjuncts)

(2) I won't properly explain my paper



1. That SoA can be placed within a temporal and circumstantial frame by σ_2 satellites ($\approx$ second level adjuncts).

(3) **today** I won't properly explain my paper



PROPOSITION

1. Something that can be true, false or uncertain (3rd order entity)
 2. Expressed internally by verb + arguments + σ_1 satellites + σ_2 satellites
 3. Modified externally by σ_3 satellites.
- (4) **Probably** today I won't properly explain my paper

(4) **Probably** today I won't properly explain my paper

σ_4	To be honest,	probably	today	I	won't	properly	explain	my paper
		σ_3	σ_2	Arg		σ_1		Arg
				SoA				
			Proposition					
		Speech act						

SPEECH ACT

1. The fact that the speaker utters his/her sentence (4th order entity)
2. Expressed internally by verb + arguments + σ_1 satellites + σ_2 satellites + σ_3 satellites;
3. Modified externally by σ_4 satellites.

(5) **To be honest**, probably today I won't properly explain my paper

To be honest,	probably	today	I	won't	properly	explain	my paper
σ_4	σ_3	σ_2	Arg		σ_1		Arg
			SoA				
		Proposition					
	Speech act						

4.2. MODIFIER OF A (I) NP, (II) ADJECTIVE OR (III) ADVERB.

- a1 NP: noun phrase

- (6) a. A man [**like you**] NP
 b. A man [**like me**] NP

- a3 Adv: adverb

- (7) a. The man drives [slowly] Adv
 b. The man drives [as slowly as you] Adv

5. LEVEL: CLAUSE CONSTITUENT

- 5.1. Manner.
- 5.2. Quality.
- 5.3. Intensity/degree.
- 5.4. Progression (?).
- 5.5. Additive focus.
- 5.6. Propositional/speech act attitude.
- 5.7. Discourse
- 5.8. Minimal pairs.

5.1 MANNER

- (8)
- a. He speaks as you (do/speak) (sub. clause)
 - b. He speaks well (adverb)
 - c. He speaks in a very formal way (PP)

Engl.	He speaks as/like you (speak) (sub. clause)
Ger.	Er spricht wie Du (sprichst) (sub. clause)
Sp.	(Él) habla como tú (hablas) (sub. clause)
Mod. Gr.	(Αυτός) μιλάει όπως εσύ (μιλάς) (sub. clause)
Anc. Gr.	(Αὐτὸς) λαλεῖ ὥσπερ σύ (λαλεῖς) (sub. clause)
Lat.	(ille) loquitur ut tu (loqueris) (sub. clause)

- Elipsis:
 - 1. Elipsis is frequent in comparative clauses and coordinations.
 - 2. Elipsis is more natural or idiomatic in many cases.

5.1.1. MANNER + CONDITION

Engl.	He speaks as if he was right (sub. clause)
Ger.	Er spricht als hätte er recht (sub. clause)
Sp.	(Él) habla como si tuviera razón (sub. clause)
Mod. Gr.	(Αυτός) μιλάει σαν να έχει δίκιο (sub. clause)
Anc. Gr.	(Αὐτός) λαλεῖ ὥσπερ (ἂν) εἰ ὀρθῶς ἔλεγε (sub. clause)
Lat.	(ille) loquitur quasi recte legat (sub. clause)

- Elipsis

- (9) a. He speaks as if he was right (sub. clause)
b. ≈ He speaks (under the X conditions) as (he would speak) if he was right
c. ≈ He speaks in the same way as (he would speak) if he was right

Like in coordinations the common material is omitted.

- Subordinators:

- (10) a. Comparative + conditional:
Engl. as if, Sp. como si, AG. ὥσπερ (ἄν) εἰ, Lat. quasi (qua + si)
b. Special constructions:
Germ. als + inversion, MG. σαν να, λες και.

- Parallel cases with other subordinates

- (11) a. I found him very quiet, as (I found him) when he suffered his first depression
b. Lo encontré muy tranquilo, como (lo encontré) cuando sufrió su primera depresión.
- (12) a. I found him very quiet in Naxos, as (I found him quiet) in Madrid
b. Lo encontré muy tranquilo en Naxos, como (lo encontré muy tranquilo) en Madrid.

5.2. QUALITY

Engl.	He speaks as a lawyer
Ger.	Er spricht als Rechtsanwalt
Sp.	(Él) habla como abogado
Mod. Gr.	(Αυτός) μιλάει ως/(σαν) δικηγόρος
Anc. Gr.	(Αὐτὸς) λαλεῖ ὡς/ᾗτε συνηγόρος
Lat.	(ille) loquitur ut iurisconsultus

(I) QUALITY (WITHOUT VERB):

Dik (1997: 231): «Quality satellites designate the role / function / authority by virtue of which an Action is carried out, or a Position maintained; they require [+con] SoAs»

- (13) a. He speaks as a lawyer¹
b. ≈ He is a lawyer and he speaks in that quality/role.

Note: The nominal phrase refers to a property and not to an entity.

(II) QUALITY VS. MANNER

- (14)
- a. He speaks like a lawyer
 - b. He is not a lawyer (probably)
 - c. $\approx$ He speaks as a lawyer would speak.
 - d. $\approx$ He speaks in the same way as a lawyer (would speak).

Note like (Manner) vs. as (Quality/Manner): Thomson & Martinet (1980³).

(III) NO VERBAL ELIPSIS: IT IS NOT A SUBORDINATE CLAUSE (QUALITY)

- (15)
- a. He speaks as a lawyer (*speaks) > Quality
 - b. He speaks as/like a lawyer (speaks) > Manner

Note connection between comparative and quality clauses:
comparative expressions > quality expressions

(IV) MEANS OF EXPRESSION: FACTORS

Lang.	Examples	Funct	Head	Art
English	He speaks as a lawyer	Quality	as	+
	He speaks like a lawyer	Manner	like	+
German	Er spricht als Rechtsanwalt	Quality	als	∅
	Er spricht wie ein Rechtsanwalt (spricht)	Manner	wie	+
Spanish	(Él) habla como abogado	Quality	como	∅
	(Él) habla como un abogado	Manner	como	+
	(Él) trabaja de/como abogado / *habla de abogado	Quality	de	∅
AGreek	(Αὐτὸς) λαλεῖ ὡς συνηγόρος	Quality	ὡς	∅
	(Αὐτὸς) λαλεῖ ὡς συνήγορός (τις) (λαλεῖ)	Manner	ὡς	(+)
	(Αὐτὸς) λαλεῖ ἅτε συνηγόρος	Quality	ἅτε	∅
	(Αὐτὸς) λαλεῖ ὥσπερ συνήγορός (τις) (λαλεῖ)	Manner	ὥσπερ	(+)
MGreek	(Αυτόςι) μιλάει ως/(σαν) δικηγόροσι	Quality	ως/(σαν)	∅
	(Αυτόςι) μιλάει σαν δικηγόροσι/σαν τον δικηγόρο μου	Manner	σαν	∅
	(Αυτόςι) μιλάει όπως ένας δικηγόροσι	Manner	σαν	+

- (a) Difference only in the header: Eng. as + a/like + a
- (b) Difference: header and article: Germ. als ø/wie + ein.
- (c) Difference: article (NP = entity or property): Sp. como ø /como + un, AGr ὡς ø /ὡς (τις)

(V) MODERN GREEK

- (a) AGr ὡς (Manner/Quality) > MGr. ως ('as', Quality).
- (b) AGr ὡς ἄν > ὡσάν > MGr. σαν:
 - (b1) 'like' (Manner)
 - (b2) 'as' (Quality): discouraged by prescriptive grammars, but everybody uses it this way (even those discouraging it)

5.3. INTENSITY/DEGREE

Language	Example
Engl.	He speaks as much as you (speak) (sub. clause)
Ger.	Er spricht so viel wie Du (sprichst) (sub. clause)
Sp.	(Él) habla tanto como tú (hablas) (sub. clause)
Mod. Gr.	(Αυτός) μιλάει τόσο όσο εσύ (μιλάς) (sub. clause)
Anc. Gr.	(Αὐτός) λαλεῖ τοσοῦτον ὅσον/οὔτως ὥς σύ (λαλεῖς) (sub. clause)
Lat.	(ille) loquitur tantum quantum tu (loqueris) (sub. clause)

(I) ORIENTATION

- (16) a. He eats as much as you do
b. He eats as much food as you do (object-oriented)
- (17) a. He sleeps as much as you do
b. He sleeps as much time as you do (duration-oriented)
- (18) a. He goes to the cinema as much as you do
b. He goes to the cinema as frequently as you do (frequency-oriented)

(II) ANALYSIS 1

Eng. as much as you, Germ. so viel wie Du

a. Diachronic analysis:

Adverb (much) modified by a comparative clause (as ... as ...)

(19) He speaks [as [much] as you (speak)]

b. Synchronic analysis:

Complex subordinator (as much as)

(20) He speaks [as much as] you (speak)

(III) ANALYSIS2:

Sp. tanto como ..., MGr. τόσο όσο ..., AGr. τοσοῦτον ὅσον ..., Lat. tantum quantum

Relative constructions: adv. + subordinator (rel. adv./conjunction)

- | | | |
|------|--|--------------------|
| (21) | a. ¡(Él) habla tanto! | > Exclamation |
| | b. 'He speaks so much!' | |
| (22) | a. (Él) habla tanto como tú (hablas) | > Intensity/Degree |
| | b. 'He speaks as much as you' | |
| (23) | a. (Él) habla como tú (hablas) | > Manner |
| | b. 'He speaks as you' (well, formally, informally) | |

5.4. PROGRESSION

Language	Example	Degree
Engl.	The more he speaks the less I understand	Comp
Ger.	Je mehr er spricht desto weniger verstehe ich	Comp
Sp.	Cuanto más habla (él) menos entiendo yo	Comp
MGr.	Όσο περισσότερο μιλάει (αυτός) τόσο λιγότερο καταλαβαίνω (εγώ)	Comp
Lat.	(ille) quam multissimum loquitur ego tam minimum intellego	Superl
AGr.	(Αὐτὸς) λαλεῖ τοσοῦτω πλεῖον/πλεῖστον ὅσω ἐλάσσον/ἐλάχιστον συνίημι	Comp/Super

(i) Subordinate character: rather than a main and subordinate clause, there seems to exist a complex construction (coordination).

(ii) Causal connection: inversion of the terms changes the sense:

- (24)
- a. The more he speaks (cause) the less I understand (effect)
 - b. ≠ The less I understand (cause) the more he speaks (effect)

5.5. ADDITIVE FOCUS

Language Example

Engl.	Like the rapporteur, I deplore the fact that the figures given in the report do not cover all state aid.
Ger.	Ebenso wie der Berichterstatter bedaure auch ich, daß die in dem Bericht enthaltenen Zahlen nicht alle staatlichen Beihilfen abdecken.
Sp.	Deploro, al igual que el ponente, que las cifras presentadas en el informe no cubran todas las ayudas estatales.

(I) ADDITIVE FOCUS VS. MANNER (REVUELTA: 2020)

(25) **Like** *the rapporteur*, I deplore the fact that [...]

a. ≠ I deplore the fact that ... **in the same way as** the rapporteur

> We both do something **in the same way**

(Manner)

b. ≈ I deplore the fact that ... and the rapporteur deplores it **too**

> We both do the same: we deplore the fact that [...]

(Additive focus)

(II) ADDITIVE FOCUS VS. COORDINATION: PRESUPPOSITION AND ASSERTION

(26) I and the rapporteur deplore the fact that the figures given in the report do not cover all state aid.

a. I deplore the fact that the figures ... (assertion)

b. The rapporteur deplores the fact that the figures ... (assertion)

(27) Like the rapporteur, I deplore the fact that the figures given in the report do not cover all state aid.

a. I deplore the fact that the figures ... (assertion)

b. The rapporteur deplores the fact that the figures ... (presupposition)

(III) SIMILITUDE WITH SO-CALLED FOCUSING PARTICLES

König (1991)

(28) Like the rapporteur, I deplore the fact that the figures given in the report do not cover all state aid.

- | | |
|--|------------------|
| a. I deplore the fact that the figures ... | (assertion) |
| b. The rapporteur deplores the fact that the figures ... | (presupposition) |

(29) I deplore too the fact that the figures given in the report do not cover all state aid.

- | | |
|---|------------------|
| a. I deplore the fact that the figures ... | (assertion) |
| b. Someone ($\neq$ I) deplores the fact that the figures ... | (presupposition) |

Note: Both constructions introduce a presupposition for alternative (sets of) entities: the subordinate identifies that entity, while the adverb keeps it unidentified.

(IV) HARMONIC CONSTRUCTIONS: COMPARATIVE + ADDITIVE FOCUS ADVERB: AS
... TOO ..., WIE ... AUCH ...

- (30) **Ebenso wie** der Berichtstatter bedaure **auch** ich, daß die in dem Berichtenthaltenen Zahlen nicht alle staatlichen Beihilfen abdecken. (sub. clause?)
a. Ich bedaure, daß ... (assertion)
b. Der Berichtstatter bedauert, daß ... (presupposition)
- (31) Η κ. Παπανδρέου, **όπως και** ο πρωθυπουργός, μίλησε για τα πολλά δισεκατομμύρια που έχει πληρώσει ο ελληνικός λαός στις ΔΕΚΟ.
(«Mrs. Papandreou, like the prime minister, spoke about the many billions that the Greek people have paid to DEKO.», ILSP 1263124)
- (32) **ὥσπερ** δὲ ἡ γῆ, **οὕτω καὶ** ἡ περὶ τὴν χώραν θάλαττα παμφορωτάτη ἐστίν
(«As productive as the land is too the sea around the coasts.», X. Vect. 1.3).

(V) DEVELOPMENT: FROM COMPARATIVE (FOCUS) INTO COORDINATION

- (33) a. Εμείς έχουμε την υποχρέωση να συμμετέχουμε στην εκπόνηση των κατευθυντήριων γραμμών, καθώς και στην αξιολόγηση των αποτελεσμάτων.
- b. We are obliged to participate in drafting directives and also in assessing their results.
- c. Nosotros tenemos la obligación de participar en la elaboración de las directrices y también en la evaluación de los resultados.

Language	Comparative conjunction	Coordinating conjunction
English	as	A ... as well as ... B
German	wie	A ... sowohl ... als auch ... B
Spanish	como	A ... tanto ... como ... BA ... así como ... B
MGreek	όσο	A ... τόσο ... όσο ... BA ... καθώς και ... BA ... όπως και ... B

5.6. PROPOSITIONAL/SPEECH ACT ATTITUDE

Quirk et alii (1985: 1112-1118): 'comment clauses'

Language	Example
English	As Peter says, you should never believe lawyers
German	Wie Peter sagt, Du solltest/solltest Du keinen Rechtsanwälten glauben (sub. clause? > no inversion)
Spanish	Como Pedro dice, no debes creer a los abogados
MGreek	Όπως λέει ο Πέτρος, δε θα έπρεπε να πιστέψεις τους δικηγόρους
AGreek	ώς/ώσπερ λέγει ο Πέτρος, συνηγόροις σε οὐ δεῖ πιστεύειν
Latin	ut Petrus dicit, non decet iurisconsultis credere

Paraphrase: the subordinate comments that the content conveyed by the main clause belongs to the things Peter says.

(I) DIFFERENCES WITH MANNER

(34) As Peter says, you should never believe lawyers

- a. $\approx$ According to Peter/In Peter's opinion you should never believe lawyers (Propositional Attitude)
- b. $\neq$ You should never believe lawyers in the way Peter says (you should believe them) (Manner)

(II) SCOPE

It is not a constituent of the main clause (predication), but takes the sentence (proposition) as a predicate (it is its logical object/subject)

(35) As Peter says, you should never believe lawyers

c. Peter says that you should never believe lawyers

5.7. DISCOURSE LEVEL

Plutarch's Life of Dion

[illegible]

5.8. CLAUSE LEVEL: MINIMAL PAIRS

- (36) a. Peter spoke as we expected (Manner).
(= Peter spoke and he did so in the way we expected him to speak).
b. As we expected, Peter spoke (Propositional Attitude).
(= We expected that Peter would speak and he did so).
c. Peter spoke, as we expected (Propositional Attitude).
- (37) a. Peter worked as/like the doorman (Manner/Degree).
(= Peter worked in the same way/with the same intensity as the doorman).
b. Peter worked as a doorman (Quality).
(= Peter was a doorman and he worked in that quality/role).

- (38) a. Peter spoke yesterday like John (Manner)
(= Peter spoke yesterday and he did so in the same way as John).
b. Peter — like John — spoke yesterday (Additive Focus).
(= Peter spoke yesterday and John did so too).
- (39) a. Peter spoke yesterday as I told you before (Manner)
(= Peter spoke yesterday and he did so in the way I told you before he did).
b. As I told you before, Peter spoke yesterday (Speech attitude).
(= I have told you this before that Peter spoke yesterday).

6. LEVEL: NP MODIFIERS

Comparative clauses can modified the internal structure of NP

Language	Example
Engl.	A man like you (are) (sub. clause)
Ger.	Ein Mann wie Du (bist) (sub. clause)
Sp.	Un hombre como tú (eres) (sub. clause)

(I) FEATURES:

a. The NP may refer to an entity or to a set of entities (generic meaning). b. The entity or the set exhibits the same qualities as the entity headed by the comparative clauses:

- (40)
- a. A man like you
 - b. $\approx$ Any man/all men who is/are like you

(II) EQUIVALENCE TO OTHER NP MODIFIERS

- (41)
- | | |
|--|----------------|
| a. [A man like you (are)] shouldn't behave that way | (comp. clause) |
| b. [An educated man] shouldn't behave that way | (adj.) |
| c. [A man who is educated] shouldn't behave that way | (rel. clause) |
| d. [A man of your education] shouldn't behave that way | (PP) |

(III) EXCEPTIONS:

Quality/Class relative clauses:

qualis and οἷος agree in case, gender and number with a NP of the subordinate clause (tu and σύ)

Language	Example	Translation
Latin	vir (talis) qualis; tu; (es)	'a man like you'
Ancient Greek	άνήρ (τοιοῦτος) οἷος; σύ; (εἶ)	'a man like you'

(IV) OTHER SYNTACTIC POSITIONS

Language	Example	Translation
Engl.	He is intelligent	(adj. attributive)
	He is like you (are)	(sub. clause)
Ger.	Er ist klug	(adj. attributive)
	Er ist wie Du (bist)	(sub. clause)
Sp.	(Él) es listo	(adj. attributive)
	(Él) es como tú (eres)	(sub. clause)

(V) CONCLUSION:

Comparative clauses can be used to ascribe properties to Nouns or NP: they operate as restrictors or modifiers.

7. LEVEL: ADJECTIVAL MODIFIERS

Language	Example
Engl.	He is as tall as you (are)
Ger.	Er ist so groß wie Du (bist)
Sp.	(Él) es tan alto como tú (eres)
Mod. Gr.	(Αυτός) είναι τόσο ψηλός όσο εσύ (είσαι)
Anc. Gr.	(Αὐτὸς) ἔστι οὕτως μέγας ὥς σύ (εἶ)
Lat.	(ille) est ita longus ut tu (es)

(42)	a. He is tall	(positive degree)
	b. He is [as tall as you (are)]	(comparison, equality)
	c. He is [taller than you (are)]	(comparison, superiority)
	d. He is [less tall than you (are)]	(comparison, inferiority)
	e. He is [very tall]	(superlative absolute)
	f. He is [the tallest]	(superlative relative)

8. LEVEL: ADVERBIAL MODIFIERS

Language	Example
Engl.	He speaks as fast as you (speak)
Ger.	Er spricht so schnell wie Du (sprichst)
Sp.	(Él) habla tan deprisa como tú (hablas)
Mod. Gr.	(Αυτός) μιλάει τόσο γρήγορα όσο εσύ (μιλάς)
Anc. Gr.	(Αὐτός) λαλεῖ οὕτως ταχέως ὥς σύ (λαλεῖς)
Lat.	(ille) loquitur ita celeriter ut tu (loqueris)

- | | | |
|------|---|---------------------------|
| (43) | a. He speaks fast | (positive grade) |
| | b. He speaks [as fast as you (speak)] | (comparison, equality) |
| | c. He speaks [faster than you (speak)] | (comparison, superiority) |
| | d. He speaks [less fast than you (speak)] | (comparison, inferiority) |
| | e. He speaks [very fast] | (superlative) |

9. DIACHRONIC DEVELOPMENTS

(A) COMPARATIVES (FOCUS) > (HEAVY) COORDINATION

Language	Comparative conjunction	Coordinative conjunction
English	as	A ... as well as ... B
German	wie/als	sowohl A ... als auch ... B
Spanish	como	tanto A ... como ... B
MGreek	όσο	τόσο A ... όσο ... BA ... καθώς και BA ... όπως και B

(I) COMMON FEATURES: ELIPSIS

(II) DIFFERENCES:

- Coordination: only assertion
- Comparative clauses: assertion + presupposition

(B) COMPARATIVES > ADDITIVE FOCUSING EXPRESSIONS

(I) SPANISH: TAMBIÉN 'TOO'

(44) Pedro habla tan bien como su padre ('Pedro speaks as well as his father')

- | | |
|-------------------------------|------------------|
| a. Pedro speaks | (assertion) |
| b. His father speaks | (presupposition) |
| c. Both speak in the same way | (Manner) |

(45) También Pedro habla ('Pedro speaks too')

- | | |
|------------------------------|------------------|
| a. Pedro speaks | (assertion) |
| b. Somebody (≠ Pedro) speaks | (presupposition) |

(II) SPANISH: TAMPOCO 'NOT EITHER'

- (46) Pedro habla **tan poco como** su padre ('Pedro speaks **as little as** his father')
- a. Pedro speaks **very little** (assertion)
 - b. His father speaks **very little** (presupposition)
 - c. Both speak **in the same degree/frequency** (Degree)
- (47) **Tampoco** Pedro habla ('Pedro doesn't speak either')
- a. Pedro does **n't** speak (assertion)
 - b. Somebody (≠ Pedro) does **n't** speak (presupposition)

(C) COMPARATIVES > COORDINATION/ADDITIVE FOCUSING

(I) ENGLISH

(48) I have to feed the animals as well as look after the children. (Swan § 91.4)

(Coordination)

(49) As well as learning to swim he has been taking Spanish lessons this summer
(Quirk et alii 1985: 708)

(Additive PP ≈ 'in addition to',
'apart from')

(50) We bought as well(Quirk et alii 1985: 604)

(Additive adverb)

10. SYNOPTIC VIEW

LEVEL	FUNCTIONS	ENGLISH	GERMAN	LATIN	SPANISH	AGREEK	MGREEK
Arg/σ ₁	Manner	like a lawyer	wie ein	ut	como	ὥσπερ/ὥς	σαν+Ac.
	Manner+Cond.	as if...	als+inver	quasi	como si	ὥσπερ εἰ	σαν να
	Intensity/Degree	as much as	so viel wie	tantum quantum	tanto como	τοσοῦτον ὅσον	τόσο όσο
	Quality	as a lawyer	als ...	ut	como	ὥς/ἄτε	ως/σαν
σ ₂ /σ ₃	Additive focus	like ... (too)	wie ... (auch)	ut... (etiam)	como ... (también)	ὥσπερ (καί)	καθώς και
σ ₃	Proposition	as	wie	ut	como	ὥσπερ/ὥς	όπως
σ ₃ /σ ₄	Speech attitude	as	wie	ut	como	ὥσπερ/ὥς	όπως
?	? Progression	the more ... the more ...	je ... desto ...	quam superl. ... tam superl. ...	cuanto ... tanto ...	τοσοῦτω... τοιούτω ...	τόσο ... όσο ...
		...as well as...	sowohl... als auch...	sic ... ut ...	tanto... como...	(καί) ...ὥσπερ (καί)...	καθώς και
Diachr.	Coord Copulative	...as well as...			también		
	Focus Additive	...as well as...					
NP	Modifier	like	wie	(talis) ... qualis ...	como	τοιούτος ... οἷος...	σαν+Ac.
Adj/Adv	Equality degree	as ... as ...	so ... wie ...	sic ... ut ...	tan ... como ...	οὕτως ... ὥσπερ...	τόσο ... όσο...

CONCLUSIONS

1. 'Comparative clause' isn't a linguistic label parallel to those applied to other subordinate clauses (temporal, causal, conditional, purpose, and so on). 'Comparison' doesn't refer to any semantic function (SF) used to classify other type of constituents: adverbs, noun phrases, prepositional phrases.
2. So-called 'Comparative clauses' can fulfill many different semantic functions and exhibit other values not always clearly classified.
3. From a diachronic point of view comparative clauses can develop into coordinating conjunctions and additive focus particles

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SOME GENERAL PIECE OF ADVICE

1. Compare as many languages as possible: sometimes a language gives you the clue for understanding others.
2. Read so as to have a general frame and organize all phenomena: finding a place for each linguistic phenomenon.
3. Read on a certain topic following a path of complexity:
 - First thinner books, later dicker books.
 - First easy books, later more difficult books.
4. Mackridge's grammar of Modern Greek.